

The Tenth Regular Meeting of the Medford School Committee

Monday, May 16, 2022

Executive Session: 5:15 PM

Regular Meeting: 6:00 PM

Held at the Howard Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall.

Join Zoom Meeting

<https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/99123771506>

Agenda

Roll Call for Attendance of Members and the Student Representatives:

Jenny Graham on zoom, Paul Ruseau on zoom, Kathy Kreatz, Sharon Hays, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Mayor Lungo-Koehn Present

Salute the Flag

Negotiations and Legal Matters - Executive Session: 5:15 PM

discussing ongoing collective bargaining negotiations with nine separate labor units.

Roll to enter Executive Session: Jenny Graham, Sharon Hays, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Lungo-Koehn: Yes

Roll to return to regular Session: Jenny Graham, Sharon Hays, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Lungo-Koehn: Yes

Consent Agenda

- Bills and Payrolls
- Regular School Committee Meeting Minutes, 5.2.2022
- Special School Committee Meeting Minutes, 5.9.2022
- Special School Committee Meeting Minutes, 5.10.2022

Motion to approve the consent agenda.

Roll to : Jenny Graham, Sharon Hays, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Lungo-Koehn: Yes 7/0

Consent agenda approved

Report of the Superintendent

- 1. Superintendent's Updates and Comments - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent**

Good Evening. Despite all of the great things going on in the Medford Schools, I unfortunately must open my remarks tonight by expressing sadness and grief over this past weekend's mass shooting in Buffalo. Now designated a hate crime, the tragic killing of 11 and wounding of 2 at a supermarket, reminds us all that racism and gun violence are scourges facing our nation. Targeting a market in a predominantly Black neighborhood, the gunman replicated tragic acts that have become far too familiar to us all. I know teachers and counselors are working hard with our students to deal with the emotional trauma caused by this terrible event. Although our nation aspires to goals of equity and inclusion, events such as this remind us of so much that has to be done. The students and staff of Medford Public Schools are striving to achieve these goals on a daily basis and are committed to eliminating discrimination of all kinds in our society. I kindly request a moment of silence for those lost in Buffalo.

Thank you to the Mayor for coming to the High School as well as the Italian Consulate who came to recognize the high level of work achieved by the students studying Italian at Medford High School. Congratulations to the students and teachers who have helped them reach these accomplishments. Thank you to the parents and grandparents who came out to support the students as well.

On a more positive note, I must take the opportunity to extend our congratulations to Ms. Whalen & Ms. Cowdrey's 8th grade ELA students from the Andrews Middle School who were selected as finalists in NPR's Student Podcast Challenge! Over 2400 schools submitted their podcasts in middle school and high school divisions. Twice in the past three years, Andrews students have received honorable mentions. This year the Andrews was recognized as one of the top ten middle school entries in the competition! At the end of this week, the students will be notified if they are the grade prize winner. They are already winners to us! Great job Mustangs!

May is Mental Health Awareness Month and the Girls Lacrosse Team decided to host a fundraiser for The Youth Mental Health Project, at their game Saturday against Malden. This specific organization has an emphasis on helping to improve mental health with teens and young adults. The team, through raffles and t-shirt sales, raised over \$500 dollars which will be donated to the Youth Mental Health Project. The Mustangs won the game 11-5! We love to hear how our students are giving back to our community!

Speaking of giving back, some of you may have stopped by Medford High School this afternoon to see all the wonderful and unique projects that the CCSR school wide organization developed this year. Once again, a fabulous job by all of our CCSR students, advisors and community partners!

And this is certainly a busy time of year and happily our schools have been hosting many in-person events. I had the pleasure of attending both the band & orchestra concerts at Chevalier. The auditorium was filled with proud parents, caregivers, family members and friends, and all of the students entertained us wonderfully! Great job to those students, Ms. Rello and our Fine Arts teachers and staff. Other recent events included,

- The McGlynn Middle School's Drama Club's presentation of the play "Super Scary"
- The CCSR awards ceremony

- Open houses at both middle schools for our rising 6th graders
- A welcome for Kindergarten families at all of our elementary schools
- The Credit for Life Financial Literacy Fair for MHS Seniors

Lastly, we appreciate that CBS 4 News Reporter Tiffany Chan took time out of her busy schedule to come to our Media Class on the Vocational side of the house, to offer her tips and tricks on how to communicate effectively, efficiently and with flourish so those watching will be both informed and entertained!

We have even more events planned in the next two weeks:

Tomorrow, Tuesday, May 17th - National Honor Society Induction - 7 PM - Caron Theater

Wednesday, May 18th - Haitian Flag Day Ceremony - 1:30 PM - MHS

Thursday, May 19th - Student Leadership Awards - 7 PM - Caron Theater

Friday, May 20th - Junior Prom - 6:30 PM - Woburn Hilton & the Up All Night program will immediately follow the prom- Junior class parents are still looking for parent volunteers for this event!

And next week, our senior class celebrations begin:

- Monday, May 23rd - Academic Awards Ceremony - 6:30 PM - Caron Theater
- Tuesday, May 24th - M Club Student Athlete Ceremony - 6 PM - Caron Theater
- Wednesday, May 25th - Senior Scholarship Night - 6:30 PM - Caron Theater
- Thursday, May 26th - Senior Prom - 7 PM - Burlington Marriott
- Friday, May 27th - Senior Day - Breakfast, Yearbook Distribution & Sponsor a Senior gift distribution - 10 AM - Cafe 2 & Courtyard
- Tuesday, May 31st - Senior BBQ - 6 PM - West Courtyard
- Wednesday, June 1st - Curtis Tufts High School Graduation Ceremony - 11 AM - Irish American Club, Malden
- And last but not least the Graduation ceremony for the Medford Class of 2022 will be held on Wednesday, June 1st at 6 PM at Hormel Stadium

In closing, it has been so nice to see more smiling faces this Spring but COVID is rising again in Middlesex County. While we are not mandating masks at this time, I do encourage people to wear them whenever attending indoor activities.

Melanie McLaughlin: I would like to highlight a couple of projects that I saw at the CCSR fair today. English Language giveback program offering translations, Ukrainian fundraiser, Mystic River Cleanup, Seeds to Feed garden project, CCSR memorial garden recognizing people lost during COVID. Mr. Skorker for helping the students.

Breanna Lungo-Koehn: Mr. Trotta and Mr. Skorker are great leaders of this program. Members of the Cummings Foundation attended today as well.

Sharon Hays; I just want to add that the elementary and middle schools participate as well.

2. Presentation on Professional Development for Administrators - Dr. Carmen Williams, HGSE Superintendent Resident

Before I start my presentation, I want to thank the administration for allowing me the opportunity to come to Medford and learn with you.

[Link to Presentation](#)

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: We are so thankful for all the work you have done. Congratulations.

Melanie McLaughlin: This partnership with Harvard has been so helpful to us. I hope you keep in touch.

3. Report on the Credit for Life event held on May 6, 2022 at Medford High School - Dr. Bernadette Ricciardelli, Director of Curriculum and Instruction

[Link to report](#)

Bernadette Ricciardelli: 237 students from the Senior Class. It was voluntary so this was a great attendance rate.

Supt. Edouard-Vincent: Thank you for organizing this event and thank you for the community volunteers and the donations from local businesses. I hope we can do this for Juniors and Seniors in the future. It was a great learning experience for our students.

4. FY 23 MPS Operating Budget Update - Assistant Superintendent of Finance and Operations David Murphy

This is our third substantive discussion related to developing the FY 23 budget.

[Link to slides](#)

Concerning the Ch. 70 which supports 20% of our budget; local budget covers 80%.

At the May 10th meeting, pertaining to the budget surveys, the development process is an attempt to balance transparency and our budgetary responsibility. It is not a drive to raise the number as much as possible. Not every idea you receive as a result of the survey data does not have equal weight in prioritization. As this budget develops, we need to develop efficiencies and find savings. Our budget has to connect to the benefit of students. It has to be ambitious, yet strategic and responsible.

Paul Ruseau: I hope that the city council wants to discuss food insecurity. The numbers on the last slide did not include free and universal food. Be prepared for the question about how we are going to address food insecurity in Medford? We should be prepared for the city council to have something to say on the matter.

Dave Murphy: Thank you Mr. Ruseau. This is a work in progress. It may be a mute point if it is incorporated into the state budget. I will do my best to provide consistent answers.

Jenny Graham: My question is about the next steps? Based on what you outlined here, we will need to take a vote to make a request. When will we do that?

Dave Murphy: We welcome more feedback and more time. It is the administration's responsibility to plan for contingencies. We will most likely present the superintendent's number at the next meeting. It would be best if we don't overestimate this number. Looking at Slide 26, there is an open question around category B which does not need to be covered by the municipal contribution.

Melanie: Could you articulate what feedback you want? When will we get the draft budget books?

Dave Murphy: Next week. The salaries and the timing make it a draft. We need to make decisions about category B and E. B has an identified funding source outside of the municipality.

Breanna Lungo-Koehn: Our CFO came on board a couple of weeks ago and we will update when we have more figures.

Jenny Graham: In terms of our presentation on our requests, the budget book in its prior form made more sense when we had the city's appropriation number. The strategic priorities are summed up in this presentation. We need to make it clear what budget we would need to provide free lunch. If one slide could tell this story. Doing the budget books right now is just too early and may be misleading. Is there urgency getting this finalized so the request can go to City Council prior to June 6.

Dave Murphy: Yes I didn't mean the next school meeting, I meant the next time we meet on the budget. If we can wait on the scheduling of the meeting, that would be helpful. I will have a more solid sense of the timeline before the end of this week.

Jenny Graham: I am wondering what my colleagues think about this topic.

Sharon Hays: I will need to look at tonight's presentation for the categorization. When would be the opportunity to ask about some of the detailed priorities.

Dave Murphy: Right now or next meeting.

Melanie McLaughlin: Is there an opportunity for public feedback.

Dave Murphy: Yes we will have that session.

Sharon Hays: I would like to look at category D and E. I have a question about math interventionists.

Dave Murphy: Math Interventionists would have value but have to weigh against other budgetary needs. It might have more value in future years when the curriculum is in place.

Sharon Hays: I am concerned if we wait. We have at least two cohorts who were not physically present in school when the foundational skills should have been built. We have not spoken about what the assessments have shown.

Dave Murphy: The data may bear that out. The point is well taken but we have to take consideration of obstacles.

Continued Business

- 2022-11 Policy BDG - SCHOOL ATTORNEY - be referred to the Rules and Policy Subcommittee for recommended updates. The Policy below was thereby approved by the Rules and Policy Subcommittee on 4/25/2022.

Committee Attorney

It will be the duty of the counsel for the Committee to advise the School Committee and the Superintendent on the specific legal problems submitted to them. The counsel for the Committee will attend meetings upon request and will be sufficiently familiar with Committee policies, practices, and actions under these policies, and with requirements of the school law to enable them to offer the necessary legal advice.

A decision to seek legal advice or assistance on behalf of the school district will be made by the Committee. The Superintendent may also take such action on behalf of or at the direction of the Committee.

Many types of legal assistance are routine and do not require specific Committee approval or prior notice. However, when the Superintendent concludes that unusual types or amounts of professional legal service may be required that exceed the budgeted retainer, the Superintendent will advise the Committee and seek either initial or continuing authorization for such service.

Individual members may not utilize the services of legal counsel without specific Committee approval. This does not preclude individual member contact with legal counsel related to ongoing legal questions or matters before the Committee.

Roll Call: Jenny Graham, Sharon Hays, Kathy Kreatez, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Lungo-Koehn 7/0 Motion Passes

New Business

2022-29 Offered by Paul Ruseau

The Policy on Public Comment and Presentations of the Public (BEDH) will be the following section appended:

"IV. Employees of the Medford Public Schools are exempt from the residency requirement of this policy. The voice of our employees is welcomed on all matters before this body. When a non-Medford-resident employee is participating in public comment or submitting a presentation of the public they will include their home address and identify themselves as an employee of the Medford Public Schools."

Meeting Date Requested: 5/16/2022

Submitted Date: 5/3/2022

Motion to approve: Melanie McLaughlin/Sharon Hays

Roll Call: Jenny Graham, Sharon Hays, Kathy Kreatez, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Lungo-Koehn; 7/0

Motion passes

2022-30 Offered by Paul Ruseau

The following changes do not change the policy of the Medford School Committee - but merely bring the language in compliance with our recently approved updates as part of our Rules adoption on March 21, 2022.

The adoption of the Rules of the School Committee superseded several elements of our published policies requiring ongoing cleanup to bring published policies up to date. Policy BEDH - Policy on Public Comment and Presentations of the Public will therefore have the sentences "3) The Chair will ask the Vice Chair "Are there any other public comments you have received?". If there are, they will be read." stricken from the policy, and "4) The Chair will proceed with the item to engage the Committee." will be renumbered "3".

Further, the sentences "Residents may also submit their comments by writing to the Superintendent of Schools or emailing superintendent@medford.k12.ma.us prior to the meeting, or by emailing medfordsc@medford.k12.ma.us prior to or during the item on the agenda. Written comments must be kept to a length that allows for them to be read into the record in less than three (3) minutes or the comments will be summarized by the Secretary of the School Committee." will be stricken from the policy.

Further, the language "When writing or emailing, please provide this required information: ..." including the 1-4 items related to what to submit when sending in written comments will be stricken from the policy as it is no longer the policy of the School Committee that emails or other forms of written public comment will be read into the record.

Meeting Date Requested: 5/16/2022

Submitted Date: 5/3/2022

Motion to waive reading: Paul Ruseau/Melanie McLaughlin 7/0 reading is waived

Paul Ruseau: When we revised the rules, we authorized my going through policies and finding policies that were out of date.

Motion to approve/Melanie McLaughlin/Sharon Hays:

Roll: Jenny Graham, Sharon Hays, Kathy Kretz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Lungo-Koehn: yes 7/0 paper passes

2022-31 Offered by Jenny Graham

Be it resolved that the School Committee will hold a Committee of the Whole, no later than 5/27/2022 to receive the Superintendent's self evaluation. Be it further resolved, that committee members will individually complete their rankings no later than 6/3/2022 using the google form created for this purpose and sent to the Secretary for compilation. Be it also resolved that a second Committee of the Whole will be convened no later than 6/10/2022 where the School Committee will discuss and deliver its evaluation of the Superintendent.

Meeting Date Requested: 5/16/2022

Submitted Date: 5/4/2022

Melanie McLaughlin: I know the process was new last year with the google docs. Did we have a primer on the process or do we need to create that? If I understand correctly, the secretary will begin the process.

Jenny Graham: Yes. The secretary will do that. I am happy to help member Hays as well.

Melanie McLaughlin: I suggest we create it for posterity; a description of the process of using the google form.

Motion to approve as amended by Melanie McLaughlin: seconded by Kathy Kreatz

Roll: Jenny Graham, Sharon Hays, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Lungo-Koehn: yes 7/0 paper passes

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: motion passes as amended

2022-32 Offered by Paul Ruseau

The Medford School Committee will add a Regular meeting on June 13, 2022.

Meeting Date Requested: 5/16/2022

Submitted Date: 5/4/2022

Paul: I added this because we didn't have a second meeting scheduled.

Motion to approve: Melanie McLaughlin/Kathy Kreatz

Roll: Roll: Jenny Graham, Sharon Hays, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Lungo-Koehn: yes 7/0 paper passes

2022-33 Offered by Jenny Graham

Be it resolved that the School Committee will meet in a Committee of the Whole to discuss the Superintendent's goals for the 2022-2023 school year, no later than 6/17/2022. Be it further resolved that the School Committee will finalize and approve the Superintendent's goals in a regular School Committee meeting or a Special School Committee meeting no later than 9/30/2022.

Meeting Date Requested: 5/16/2022

Submitted Date: 5/12/2022

Sharon Hays: This seems like a tight turnaround.

Jenny Graham: In thinking about the timeline, we always run out of time at the end of the year. The superintendent and I discussed this. I was hoping we would agree on the goals in June so the Admin team could work over the summer on the goals. The supt. Informed me that a lot of data comes in over the summer so we could use this time.

This resolution changes the process so that it gives us time to tweak the goals and also for her to hear from the committee what they are hoping for.

This first meeting is just a discussion of the goals. I feel she should hear from us proactively about what we feel these goals should be. I think it is more of an opportunity to hear from us.

Supt. Edouard-Vincent; I had the opportunity to talk to member Graham about this and I welcome this discussion with the committee but I shared that it is important to reflect as a team over the summer months to make data informed decisions.

Motion to approve:

Roll: Jenny Graham, Sharon Hays, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Lungo-Koehn: yes 7/0 paper passes

2022-34 Offered by Jenny Graham

Be it resolved that the Communication and Family Engagement subcommittee will review and recommend updates to the School Committee related to MPS' attendance and truancy policies which include:

JEC - High School Class Attendance Policy

JED - Middle School Attendance and Tardiness Policy

JF-R - Uniform Registration and Attendance Policy

JHBA - Duties of the Supervisor of Attendance

JHB - Truancy

Meeting Date Requested: 5/16/2022

Submitted Date: 5/4/2022

Jenny Graham: This is the list of policies we mentioned at the last subcommittee meeting that we didn't get time to address so I propose we bring it to the subcommittee.

Motion to approve: Melanie McLaughlin/Kathy Kreatz

Roll: Jenny Graham, Sharon Hays, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Lungo-Koehn: yes 7/0 paper passes

2022-35 Offered by Paul Ruseau

The Wellness Policy (ADF) for K-8 students is referred to the Rules and Policy Subcommittee for revision and that it be revised as necessary to ensure unrestricted free play recess is available to all K-8 children daily as part of their social and emotional wellbeing. The curtailing of unrestricted free play recess shall be tracked. This information shall be returned to the School Committee twice each year and be disambiguated by school, grade, gender, race, disability, and socioeconomic status. The subcommittee shall invite at least one teacher and administrator from grades K-5 and 6-8, as well as the director of student services or her designee, to ensure their views are considered. The current policy and recommended revised policy will be returned to this committee no later than our first meeting in November of 2022.

Meeting Date Requested: 5/16/2022

Submitted Date: 5/11/2022

Paul Ruseau: In June of 2020, this was on the agenda. I brought this back as it is very important. More research is coming out that taking away recess has a negative effect.

Motion to approve: Melanie McLaughlin/Sharon Hays

Roll: Jenny Graham, Sharon Hays, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Lungo-Koehn: yes 7/0 paper passes

Reports Requested

2022-27 - Update on Implementation of NWEA MAP offered by members Sharon Hays, Melanie McLaughlin and Mea Mustone from our March 21, 2022 meeting.

Condolences

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of Virginia F. “Ginny” O’Neill, who served as a lunch mother at the former Franklin Elementary School and the Roberts Elementary School.

Next Meeting

- **Monday, June 6 , 2022, 6:00 PM: Regular School Committee Meeting** - Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall in addition to zoom: <https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/91697745538>

Adjournment: Motion to adjourn: Melanie/Kathy Kreatz

Roll: Jenny Graham, Sharon Hays, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Mayor Lungo-Koehn: yes 7/0 meeting adjourned.